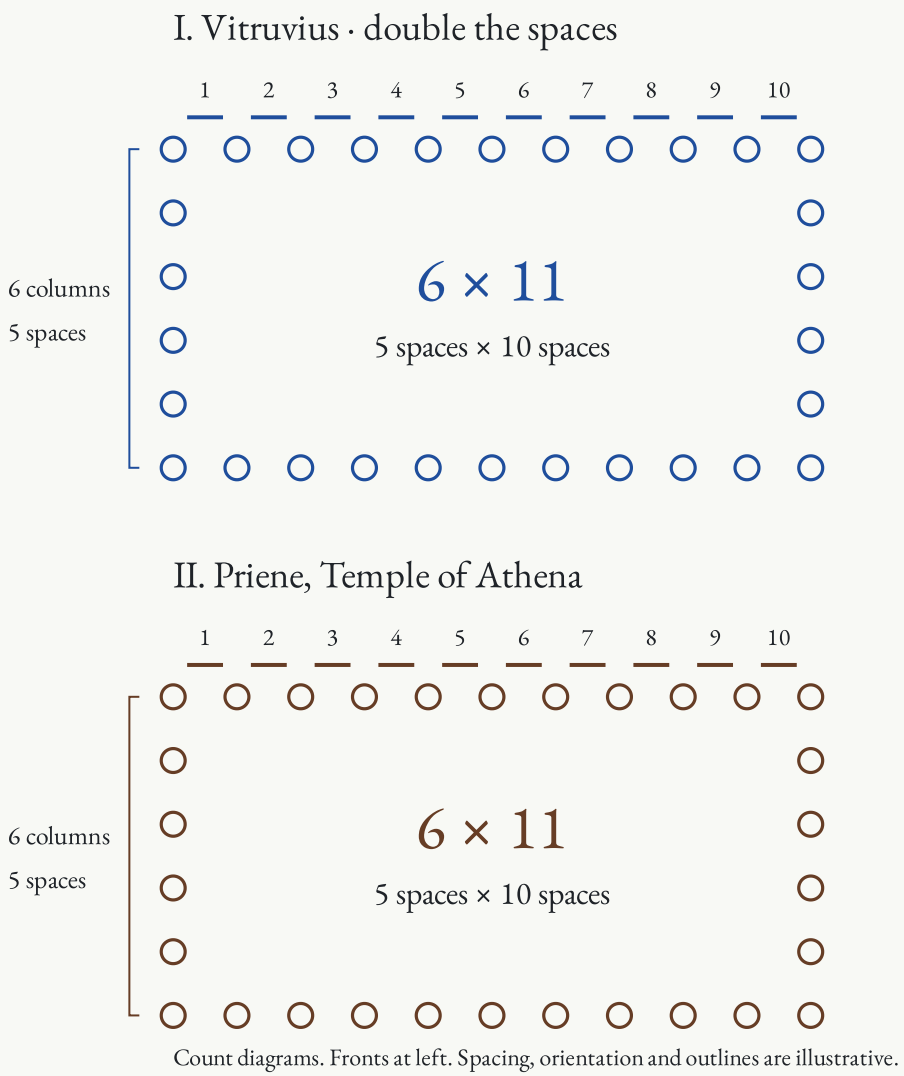
Count the spaces

Priene, Temple of Athena beside Vitruvius's count.



Count diagrams. Fronts at left. Spacing, orientation and outlines are illustrative.

The selected reading predicts 11 flank columns. The catalogue records 11. Six columns enclose five spaces. Doubling five spaces gives ten, with eleven columns at their ends; doubling six columns gives twelve, with eleven spaces.

These are count diagrams with equal spacing, not measured plans. Matching a count cannot show that a builder followed Vitruvius. The buildings mostly precede his first-century BCE treatise. This curated catalogue is not a census.

The building record

Priene, Temple of Athena

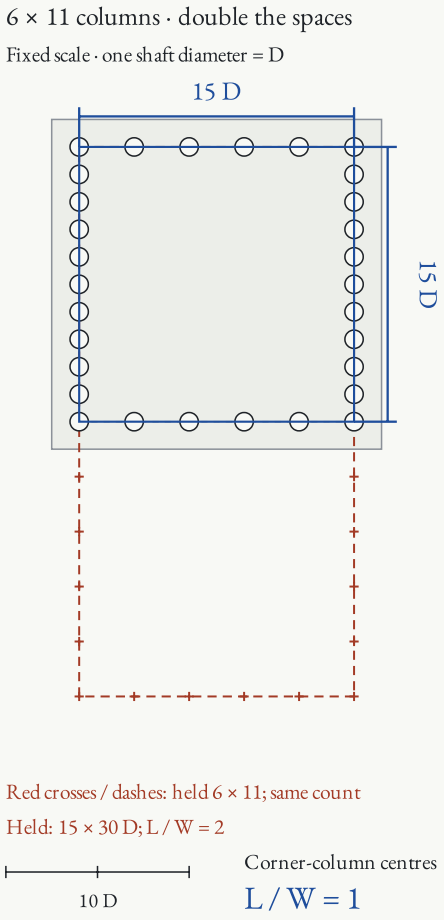
ca. 340 BC - ca. 150 BC · Ionia

> "Hexastyle peripteral temple with eleven columns on the sides"

Perseus does not flag this column count as uncertain.

Read the Perseus entry ↗

Twice as long, measured where?



Current: 6 × 11. Held reference: 6 × 11. Column count unchanged. The two trials share one D and drawing scale.

Current trial · D is one shaft diameter

Endpoints	Width / D	Length / D	L / W
Corner-column centres	15	15	1
Outside shaft faces	16	16	1
Trial platform edges	18	18	1

Held reference · same D and drawing scale

Endpoints	Width / D	Length / D	L / W
Corner-column centres	15	30	2
Outside shaft faces	16	31	1.9375
Trial platform edges	18	33	1.8333

Current trial

Count only from Priene, Temple of Athena: 6 × 11. No dimensions are taken from this building. The trial has 5 front spaces and 10 flank spaces. The space count is doubled.

Centre width = 5 × 3 = 15 D. Centre length = 10 × 1.5 = 15 D. Outside shaft faces add 1 D to each dimension; the trial platform adds another 2 × 1 D.

Count source: Priene, Temple of Athena. Read the source record. Catalogue count not flagged as uncertain. Perseus Digital Library, Tufts University; retained 2026-10-29; https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/us/.

> Hexastyle peripteral temple with eleven columns on the sides

Modern experiment: uniform circular shafts, uniform pitch within each direction and the same margin on all four sides. Width runs across the front; length runs along the flank, even when it is shorter. No bases, walls, steps, corner contraction or surveyed

dimensions. The grey platform is a chosen boundary. A count alone determines none of these distances. These endpoints are comparisons, not a claim to settle what Vitruvius meant by *longitudo operis*.

Held reference

Count only from Priene, Temple of Athena: 6 × 11. No dimensions are taken from this building. The trial has 5 front spaces and 10 flank spaces. The space count is doubled.

Centre width = 5 × 3 = 15 D. Centre length = 10 × 3 = 30 D. Outside shaft faces add 1 D to each dimension; the trial platform adds another 2 × 1 D.

Count source: Priene, Temple of Athena. Read the source record. Catalogue count not flagged as uncertain. Perseus Digital Library, Tufts University; retained 2026-10-29; https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/us/.

> Hexastyle peripteral temple with eleven columns on the sides

Modern experiment: uniform circular shafts, uniform pitch within each direction and the same margin on all four sides. Width runs across the front; length runs along the flank, even when it is shorter. No bases, walls, steps, corner contraction or surveyed dimensions. The grey platform is a chosen boundary. A count alone determines none of these distances. These endpoints are comparisons, not a claim to settle what Vitruvius meant by *longitudo operis*.

The table rounds to four decimal places; the CSV retains JavaScript number precision. The diagram retains its fixed scale. This is a modern measuring experiment, not a reconstruction of the selected building.

Measurements CSV · Trial plan SVG · Reopenable comparison JSON

▶ Exact saved choices

Vitruvius III.4.3

ita columnae in peripteris conlocentur, uti, quot intercolumnia sunt in fronte, totidem bis intercolumnia fiant in lateribus; ita enim erit duplex longitudo operis ad latitudinem. namque qui columnarum duplicationes fecerunt, erravisse videntur, quod unum intercolumnium in longitudine plus quam oporteat procurrere videtur.

In peripteral temples set the columns so that the flanks have twice as many intercolumniations as the front; then the length of the work will be double its width. Those who doubled the columns seem to have erred, because the length then appears to run on by one intercolumniation more than it should.

Latin: Krohn (1912), p. 69; new English translation, not independently reviewed. Printed witness.

Temple records: Perseus Digital Library, Tufts University; CC BY-SA 3.0 US. Retained 2026-10-29. Data license. Original diagram and English: Copyright 2026 Anthony Mercer, PolyForm Noncommercial 1.0.0. This file retains both drawings, the trial, the selected record, one complete Latin source page, fonts and full licenses. It needs no network to read, download its native files or print. External source links need a connection.

Reopen this complete comparison

▶ Original code, diagrams and English: PolyForm Noncommercial 1.0.0
▶ Embedded EB Garamond: SIL Open Font License 1.1

Complete printed page 69, including the apparatus. F. Krohn, *Vitruvii De architectura libri decem*, Leipzig, 1912. Public domain. Original archive image. The excerpt is in lines 3–9; the page also contains other sections.

pycnostyla, sive systylo aut diastylo aut eustylo, quemadmodum supra scripta sunt et constituta. in araeostylis enim libertas est quantum cuique libet constituendi. sed ita co-
(10) lumnae in peripteris conlocentur, uti, quot intercolumnia
5 sunt in fronte, totidem bis intercolumnia fiant in lateribus; ita enim erit duplex longitudo operis ad latitudinem. namque qui columnarum duplicationes fecerunt, erravisse videntur, quod unum intercolumnium in longitudine plus quam
(15) oporteat procurrere videtur. gradus in fronte constituendi 4
10 ita sunt, uti sint semper inpares; namque cum dextro pede primus gradus ascendatur, item in summo templo primus erit ponendus. crassitudines autem eorum graduum ita finiendas censeo, ut neque crassiores dextante nec tenuiores
(20) dodrante sint conlocatae; sic enim durus non erit ascensus.
15 retractiones autem graduum nec minus quam sesquipedales nec plus quam bipedales faciendae videntur. item si circa aedem gradus futuri sunt, ad eundem modum fieri debent. sin autem circa aedem ex tribus lateribus podium faciendum
(25) erit, id constituatur, uti quadrae, spirae, trunci, coronae,
20 lysis ad ipsum stylobatam, qui erit sub columnarum spiris,
77 conveniant. stylobatam ita oportet exaequari, uti habeat per medium adiectionem per scamillos inpares; si enim ad libellam dirigetur, alveolatum oculo videbitur. hoc autem, ut scamilli ad id convenientes fiant, item in extremo libro
) 25 forma et demonstratio erit descripta.

His perfectis in suis locis spirae conlocentur, eaeque ad V symmetriam sic perficiantur, uti crassitudo cum plintho sit columnae ex dimidia crassitudine proiecturamque, quam Graeci εκφοραν vocitant, habeant s extantem; ita tum lata
) 30 et longa erit columnae crassitudinis unius et dimidiae. alti- 2

---

1 euastilo *S* 4 quot GS^c: quod *HS* 10 sunt *G*: sint *HS* ut *S* 13 dextante *G*: extantąe *H*, -tę *S* 15 retractiones *GS*: retractationes HS^c 19 id *Kr*: ad id (*cum* ad *add.*) *x* spinę *S* 20 lysis HS^cG^c: lapis *G* ipsum *H*: ipsam *G et in ras. S* qui erit — stylobatam *om. S* (*suppl.* S^c) columnarum *Rode*: columna HS^c, columnę *G* 29 s (*i. e.* semisse) extantem (*cf. 271, 7*) *Kr*: sextantem *x* tum *HS*: dum *G*